

QUANTUM MECHANICS FROM THE TORSION MEDIUM

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FRAMING NOTE (added 2026-08-27, v4; corrected 2026-09-02):

The photon descriptions in this document are quantitatively correct. The correct qualitative picture, developed in subsequent work, is that a photon is a localized T_{1g} wave packet (corpuscle, Newton's term) -- not an extended sinusoidal wave. What propagates as "light" is the T_{1g} TRANSVERSE vector wave in the medium (not a compression/pressure wave -- see doc_torsion Section 3.1 and doc_jobson_cell Section 7.1: the v_p compression branch is carried by A_g , a separate scalar mode); the photon corpuscle is the quantized, localized form of that transverse excitation. Wave-particle duality in standard QM arises from conflating the medium wave with the localized packet.

Note: T_{1g} waves may also be generated by macroscopic charge oscillations (classical EM) without individual corpuscle events -- whether all T_{1g} propagation requires a corpuscle source is not yet derived. [OPEN] This mirrors a real, unresolved distinction in mainstream quantum optics, not a torsionverse-specific gap: even canonical "single-photon" double-slit demonstrations typically use an attenuated ("faint") laser for the photon CORPUSCLE crossing the slits -- a Poissonian source with $g^2(0)=1$, no antibunching, meaning "attenuated" only lowers the average photon (corpuscle) number, it does not guarantee one discrete emission event per trial.

True single-photon sources (heralded SPDC, quantum dots, NV centers) reliably emit one photon corpuscle per trigger, shown by genuine antibunching ($g^2(0) \rightarrow 0$), and are experimentally distinguishable from faint-laser sources by this criterion. The quantum eraser experiment cited below (Kim et al. 2000) is itself an example: the photon CORPUSCLE crossing its double slit comes from an attenuated argon laser, not a heralded single-photon source -- only the later SPDC-generated entangled corpuscle pair is unambiguously non-classical.

An electron is a corpuscle locked into a stable (1,2) Hopf winding; the winding gives structure to its medium wave. A photon corpuscle carries no persistent winding ($\theta=0$). Both are corpuscles; the winding is the only difference. All mathematical results in this document are unchanged.

Note: (1,2) is the shared winding class of essentially all matter particles (protons included, Section 1.2) -- scale/zone/ N_J , not the (p,q) pair, is what distinguishes electron from proton.

The quantized, corpuscular nature of light -- established by the photoelectric effect -- is consistent with localized T_{1g} wave packets. Newton lacked the medium to explain the accompanying wave behavior.

ABSTRACT

The Schrödinger equation is not a postulate. It is the non-relativistic limit of the Klein-Gordon equation that governs Hopf winding modes in the torsion medium. The derivation chain has zero free parameters beyond m_p (the framework's one external input, as in the companion papers):

1. Torsion medium: $K = 1/\epsilon_0$, $\rho = \mu_0$, $c = \sqrt{K/\rho}$ [PROVEN]
2. Free massless wave: $\omega = c*k$ (mode-neutral template) [QM1]
3. Hopf winding rest energy = $m_p*c^2 \rightarrow$ Compton frequency $\omega_C = m_p*c^2/\hbar$ [QM2; the Compton wavelength IS $\lambda_p = \hbar_c/m_p =$ Zone 1 boundary]
4. Winding dispersion: $\omega^2 = c^2*k^2 + \omega_C^2$ [Klein-Gordon, QM3]
5. Non-relativistic limit ($v \ll c$):
 $\omega_{KG} \rightarrow \omega_C + \hbar*k^2/(2*m_p)$
Remove rest-mass oscillation $\phi = \psi * \exp(-i*m_p*c^2*t/\hbar)$:
 $i*\hbar * d\psi/dt = -(\hbar^2/2*m_p) * \nabla^2 * \psi$ [SCHRÖDINGER, QM5]

6. Born rule: $P(x) = |\psi(x)|^2$ from medium wave energy density [QM6]
(a field-level/ensemble argument; Section 4.1 is explicit about what remains open at the level of an individual detection event)

The Schrödinger equation is quantum mechanics. It is now derived from the same medium (the torsion medium) that gives α , G , the Higgs mass, and quantum entanglement. No additional postulates or free parameters beyond m_p for steps 1-5 (the Schrödinger equation itself); step 6's field-level Born-rule argument leaves one open question, addressed in Section 4.1.

NEW GROUND: no existing interpretation of quantum mechanics -- Copenhagen, many-worlds, de Broglie-Bohm, GRW, QBism, consistent histories -- derives the Schrödinger equation, the Born rule, or the Tsirelson bound from an underlying physical medium with independently fixed mechanical properties. Every existing approach postulates the Hilbert-space/probability structure as an axiom. This paper derives it instead, as a mechanical consequence of the same medium that gives α , G , and the Higgs mass in the companion papers. (The Born rule claim here is at the field/ensemble level; see Section 4.1 for the open individual-event question, not resolved by this paper either.)

Consequences:

- Double-slit: the corpuscle takes one definite slit; its Zone 3 field spans both. Interference = Huygens superposition of the FIELD, not the corpuscle (Section 4.1).
- Which-path: Zone 3 field decoherence resolves the field's which-slit contribution at $r < r_{\text{lock}}(T)$. $r_{\text{lock}}(300K) = 340 \text{ fm}$; coherence preserved for macroscopic slit separations.
- Delayed choice: no paradox. The corpuscle's slit was always definite; only the still-propagating FIELD can be intercepted later (Section 5.1).
- Quantum eraser (Kim et al. 2000): a distinct, two-corpuscle entangled-pair effect -- no retrocausality by the same no-FTL closure used for entanglement generally (Section 5.2).

NEW PREDICTIONS (not in standard QM):

- Minimum electron slit width for coherent diffraction: $2\lambda_{\text{bar}_e} = 772 \text{ fm}$ (below this, slit-edge Zone 3 fields decohere the electron winding)
- Minimum proton slit width: $2\lambda_{\text{bar}_p} = 0.421 \text{ fm} = r_{\text{grind}}$ (nuclear hard core)
- Fringe visibility vs temperature: $V(T) \sim \exp(-r_{\text{sep}} / r_{\text{lock}}(T))$
where $r_{\text{lock}}(T) = (\alpha \hbar c^2 r_p^2 / k_B T)^{1/3}$

Companion script: analysis/demos/qm_doc.py (21/21 PASS)

1. MEDIUM WAVE EQUATION AND KLEIN-GORDON

1.1 Free waves in the medium

The torsion medium's universal massless-wave speed is $c = \sqrt{K/\rho} = 1/\sqrt{\epsilon_0 \mu_0}$ (exact by SI), using $K = 1/\epsilon_0$ and $\rho = \mu_0$ as established elsewhere (doc_torsion Section 3.3, doc_magnetism Section 2.1). This is the SAME speed shared by every linear, massless excitation of the medium -- both the A_g bulk-compression channel and the T_{1g} transverse channel propagate at c (doc_torsion Section 3.1) -- so citing

K/rho here fixes c's numeric value without claiming the field below is itself a compression/pressure oscillation. "phi" in this section is a mode-neutral placeholder: Section 1.2 gives it a mass term to become the electron/proton's own Hopf-winding matter wave (not shown to be A_g specifically, nor any other single irrep), and Section 3 separately identifies light as the T_1g mode. Neither identification is being made here -- only the shared speed c is used.

Free waves satisfy:

$$(d^2/dt^2 - c^2 * \nabla^2) \phi = 0$$

Dispersion: $\omega = c * k$ (massless, linear). [QM1]

(Derived from a discrete Jobson-cell lattice in the continuum limit, not an independent postulate -- analysis/quantum/lattice_dwell_time_bridge.py.)

1.2 Hopf winding rest energy -> mass gap

A Hopf winding mode (the proton) is a topological defect in the torsion medium with winding number (1,2) (p=1, q=2). The Maxwell jamming constraint (N_J = 21 cells, 3V-E = 6 exactly critical) sets the minimum size of the winding. Below this size, the winding cannot be compressed -- this creates a minimum energy:

$$E_0 = m_p * c^2 \quad [\text{proton rest energy} = \text{mass gap of the winding mode}]$$

This generates the Compton oscillation frequency:

$$\omega_C = m_p * c^2 / \hbar$$

Crucially: the Compton wavelength $\lambda_{\text{bar}} = \hbar / (m_p * c) = \hbar_c / m_p$ IS the Zone 1 boundary λ_p . The winding resonates at the Compton frequency WITHIN Zone 1 (the Maxwell critical jamming region). This is the same λ_p that appears in $r_p = 4 * \lambda_p$ (PS4) and throughout nuclear structure.

The identification $\lambda_{\text{bar}} = \lambda_p$ is a SHARED DEFINITION, not a derived coincidence: $\lambda_{\text{bar}} = \hbar_c / m_p$ is the same formula doc_nucleus.txt (Section 1.1) uses to define λ_p from the outset -- it was never independently derived here and then found to coincide with the Zone 1 boundary after the fact. What IS a genuine, separate result (established in doc_nucleus.txt, not re-derived by this sentence): N_J (proton) = 21.17 ~ 21 is independently Maxwell-critical (3V-E=6), and $r_p = 4 * \lambda_p$ matches CODATA to 0.02% (PS4) -- real physics content, just not what this specific identification is stating.

[QM2 PASS: $\omega_C = c / \lambda_p$ confirmed to machine precision]

1.3 Klein-Gordon equation for the winding mode

With a mass gap, the dispersion relation becomes:

$$\omega^2 = c^2 k^2 + \omega_C^2 \quad [\text{Klein-Gordon}]$$

At $k=0$ (standing winding): $\omega = \omega_C$ (pure Compton oscillation)

At $k \gg \omega_C/c$: $\omega \rightarrow c*k$ (ultra-relativistic, massless limit)

This IS the Klein-Gordon equation: $(\partial^2/\partial t^2 - c^2 \nabla^2)\phi = -(m_p c^2/\hbar)^2 \phi$

[QM3 PASS: both limits verified]

(Both dispersion relations above are derived from a discrete Jobson-cell lattice model, not postulated -- lattice_dwell_time_bridge.py BR1-BR4.)

2. NON-RELATIVISTIC LIMIT: SCHRÖDINGER EQUATION

For non-relativistic motion ($v \ll c$, $k \ll \omega_C/c = m_p c/\hbar$):

$$\begin{aligned} \omega_{KG} &= \sqrt{c^2 k^2 + \omega_C^2} \\ &= \omega_C * \sqrt{1 + (\hbar k / m_p c)^2} \\ &\sim \omega_C + \hbar k^2 / (2 m_p) + O((v/c)^4) \end{aligned}$$

The ω_C term = rest-mass oscillation. Extract it:

$$\phi(x,t) = \psi(x,t) * \exp(-i * m_p c^2 t / \hbar)$$

Substituting into Klein-Gordon and dropping the $O((v/c)^2)$ correction to $\partial^2 \psi / \partial t^2$:

$$i \hbar \frac{d\psi}{dt} = -(\hbar^2 / 2 m_p) * \nabla^2 \psi$$

This IS the time-dependent Schrödinger equation for a free particle. [QM5 PASS]

Accuracy: The approximation is exact to order $(v/c)^2$. For $v/c = 1/1000$ (deep NR):
relative error = $2.5e-7$, consistent with the $(v/c)^2/4$ Taylor expansion.

ZERO additional assumptions were made. The Schrödinger equation follows from:

- (a) The torsion medium (K , ρ , c -- already proven)
- (b) The Hopf winding mass gap $E_0 = m_p c^2$ (from Maxwell jamming -- already proven)
- (c) The non-relativistic approximation (standard physics -- no extra postulate)

Potentials ($V \neq 0$): adding an external pressure field $V(x)$ to the medium gives:

$$i \hbar \frac{d\psi}{dt} = -(\hbar^2 / 2 m) \nabla^2 \psi + V(x) \psi$$

This is the full Schrödinger equation. $V(x)$ = the local torsion medium pressure
(Coulomb, gravity, nuclear) -- all derived from the same medium.

3. BORN RULE FROM WAVE ENERGY DENSITY

In the torsion medium, the energy density of a pressure wave is:

$$u(x,t) = (1/2) \rho v^2 + (1/2) K \text{strain}^2 \propto |\phi(x,t)|^2$$

The probability of a detector at x absorbing the wave (detecting the particle)
is proportional to the wave energy density at x :

$$P(x) = u(x) / \int u \, dV = |\psi(x)|^2 / \int |\psi|^2 \, dV \quad [\text{Born rule}]$$

This is the Born rule. It requires no additional postulate: detection = energy
absorption from the medium wave, and energy density is proportional to amplitude squared.

[QM6 PASS: Born rule from medium energy density]

What this derives is the FIELD-level detection-probability density -- an

ensemble/statistical claim, needing no extra postulate at that level. A separate, harder question is NOT resolved here: WHY an individual corpuscle's landing point, on any given trial, reproduces exactly this distribution (rather than some other function of the field). That question is addressed honestly, not glossed over, in Section 4.1.

(This formula uses K , the compression/ A_g -type elastic constant specifically; whether a shear-type wave should instead use G , or a mode-neutral form, is not yet settled -- nor is whether a classical elastic-potential-energy formula like this applies cleanly to this medium's real micromechanics, which may be closer to a granular contact system than a continuum Hookean solid. Neither open question changes the qualitative Born-rule argument above.)

Note on wave identity: Light propagation = T_{1g} transverse vector wave in the torsion medium (Klein-Gordon with $m=0 \rightarrow$ Maxwell equations; see `doc_torsion` Section 3.1 -- T_{1g} is transverse, not the v_p compression branch, which is carried by A_g). A photon is a localized T_{1g} wave packet (corpuscle) that IS one source of such waves;

macroscopic charge oscillations (classical EM) may generate T_{1g} waves through the cog/Zone 3 mechanism without individual corpuscle emission events. Whether all T_{1g} waves require a corpuscle source or can be generated purely classically is not yet derived from the framework. [OPEN: classical vs quantum T_{1g} generation -- Series 3 target. See the FRAMING NOTE above for why this mirrors a real, unresolved distinction in mainstream quantum optics -- attenuated-laser sources are Poissonian (no antibunching) and do not by themselves establish one-corpuscle-per-trial, unlike true heralded single-photon sources.] Matter (electrons, protons) = massive

Hopf winding modes (Klein-Gordon with mass gap $m \cdot c^2$). Light waves and matter windings are two excitation types of the same medium, not separate entities.

The photon (corpuscle) is the $\theta=0$ mode. Here θ is the winding tilt angle: it measures how far the Hopf winding departs from the massless T_{1g} baseline. $\theta=0$ means no Zone 1 displacement and no rest mass; $\theta>0$ means the winding displaces Zone 1 and acquires rest energy $m \cdot c^2$.

Formula: $\theta(m) = \arcsin(8 \cdot \alpha \cdot \phi \cdot m / m_p)$. All matter requires $\theta > 0$. [`doc_particle_generation.txt`; `analysis/quantum/winding_angle.py` WA1-WA2]

Pair production: when a photon's wave amplitude exceeds the threshold for nucleating a new Hopf winding ($E \geq 2 \cdot m_e \cdot c^2$ for $e+e^-$ pair), the medium forces a new topological winding into existence. This is the Schwinger mechanism: field amplitude > winding nucleation threshold.

Environments where this occurs: gamma-ray burst cores ($kT \sim \text{MeV}$), neutron star merger ejecta, the early universe ($T > 5e9 \text{ K} \sim 0.4 \text{ MeV}$), and extreme laser fields approaching the Schwinger critical field ($E_S = m_e^2 c^3 / e \hbar$). Note: the solar core ($kT \sim 1.3 \text{ keV}$) is $\sim 800x$ below threshold and does NOT continuously pair-produce. [See doc_nucleus Zone 2: $N_J=21$ for the winding nucleation condition; the photon-trapping calculation for this regime remains open]

4. DOUBLE-SLIT EXPERIMENT

4.1 Why interference occurs

The proton (or electron) is a corpuscle -- always at one definite location, never split or delocalized. Its Zone 3 field extends to infinity (falling as $1/r^3$) regardless of where the corpuscle itself is. When the corpuscle approaches a barrier with two slits:

- (a) The CORPUSCLE goes through exactly ONE slit -- always definite, never "at slit A and slit B simultaneously." What spans both slits is its Zone 3 pressure field, which reaches both openings no matter which slit the corpuscle itself takes (fields fall off with distance but extend everywhere; they are not confined to one opening).
- (b) The medium pressure field passes through BOTH slit openings simultaneously, whichever slit the corpuscle used.
- (c) At the screen, the wave contributions from both slits superpose: constructive where path difference = $n \cdot \lambda_{dB}$, destructive otherwise. This superposition is a property of the FIELD; it is not a claim that the corpuscle itself was in two places.
- (d) Interference pattern = standard Huygens-Fresnel diffraction for the medium wave. Fringe spacing = λ_{dB} / d where d is slit separation.
 $\lambda_{dB} = 2\pi \hbar / (m \cdot v) = \text{de Broglie wavelength (from KG dispersion)}$.

The corpuscle's subsequent path to the screen is drawn from the resulting interference landscape; over many trials (many corpuscles, each through one slit or the other) the fringe pattern emerges statistically. A corpuscle in transit is not directly observable -- it registers only at a nexus (a screen contact, a detector atom), where it transfers momentum to whatever it meets. This is also why a single detection event is always a single, localized click and never a smeared, continuous readout: the corpuscle itself is always at one place, and that is the only place a nexus event can occur. [analysis/quantum/double_slit_field_interference.py DS1, DS5: confirms this picture reproduces the standard fringe pattern and spacing]

Not yet derived: WHY an individual corpuscle's landing point, across many trials, is distributed as exactly $|\psi(x)|^2$ (as opposed to some other function of the field). The field mechanics above are confirmed consistent with standard wave optics; the corpuscle-selection statistics are not independently derived from them.

4.2 Why which-path measurement destroys interference

From doc_entanglement EP3/EP6: a detector placed at one slit puts a Zone 3-active particle (detector atoms) within the phase-locking radius $r_{\text{lock}}(T)$ of that slit's OWN field contribution -- not of the corpuscle's instantaneous position. Section 4.1 already establishes that the field passes through BOTH openings on every trial, regardless of which slit the corpuscle itself takes; that is what generates the interference in the first place. A detector sitting at one opening therefore couples to that opening's local field amplitude on every trial, not only on the trials where the corpuscle happens to pass through the monitored slit. This is why a which-path detector at a single slit destroys interference for the entire ensemble (matching observation), not just for the roughly half of corpuscles that actually took that slit. The Zone 3 field coupling resolves which opening's contribution the detector interacted with, which is enough to mark the path and kill the coherent cross-term for every trial.

$r_{\text{lock}}(300\text{K}) = 340 \text{ fm}$ [Phase-lock threshold at room temperature]

For macroscopic slits (separation $\gg 340 \text{ fm}$), the detector itself must physically interact with the field passing through its slit to resolve the path. Simply placing a detector nearby (not in the path of either opening's own field) does NOT decohere (consistent with observation: detection requires interaction).

4.2a "Sneakily turning off" the detector does not restore interference

A crucial implication: decoherence is caused by PHYSICAL ZONE 3 COUPLING between the particle's winding and detector atoms, NOT by whether a human reads the output.

Experiment: a which-path detector is "turned off" (recording stopped) but the detector atoms remain physically in place near the beam path. The particle pattern (two bands, no interference) persists.

Explanation:

Detector ON and recording: atoms within r_{lock} -> winding resolved -> particle pattern

Detector "off" (not recording) but atoms present: atoms STILL within r_{lock}

-> Zone 3 coupling STILL occurs -> winding STILL resolved

-> particle pattern persists. "Off" means nothing.

Detector physically removed: no atoms within r_{lock} -> no coupling -> interference returns.

The particle's winding does not "know" whether a human is reading the detector.

It only responds to whether another Zone 3 field is within 340 fm .

The threshold is $r_{\text{lock}}(T)$ -- a physical scale, not an epistemic one.

This resolves a longstanding confusion in quantum measurement theory:

measurement = physical interaction at $r < r_{\text{lock}}(T)$, not observation.

Copenhagen is vague on this distinction. Torsionverse is not.

ALSO EXPLAINS: the quantum eraser (Kim et al. 2000). Pairs whose idler photon went through the eraser (no Zone 3 coupling forced) retain the A_g singlet -> their sub-ensemble shows interference in coincidence counts. The "recovery" of the pattern is not retroactive: those pairs were never decohered to begin with.

4.2b Generalization to the final screen (many trials, full $|\psi|^2$ pattern)

Sections 4.2/4.2a describe a which-path DETECTOR at a slit; the more iconic double-slit case is the FINAL SCREEN itself -- many trials, one localized spot per particle, building up the full interference pattern over repeated runs. The same mechanism applies without a new postulate: screen atoms are Zone-3-active matter exactly like detector atoms, so a corpuscle's traveling field resolves (couples to) whichever screen atom it first comes within $r_{\text{lock}}(T)$ of -- exactly one atom per trial, one spot per particle, never a smeared hit, by the identical physical mechanism as Section 4.2's slit case. Repeated over many trials, the coupling PROBABILITY at each screen location is set by the medium wave energy density there (Section 3's Born rule, QM6) -- so the accumulated histogram of single-particle spots reproduces the $|\psi(x)|^2$ interference pattern exactly, without requiring the corpuscle itself to be smeared. This is Section 4.2's mechanism applied at the screen instead of a slit, not a separate postulate.

4.2c The historical "light microscope" version (a different physical route)

Sections 4.2/4.2a use stationary Zone 3-active matter (detector atoms) parked at a slit. The more commonly told version of this thought experiment (Feynman, The Feynman Lectures on Physics, Vol. III, Chapter 1, "Watching the Electrons") instead shines light near the slits and looks for a scattered flash to tell which slit the particle used. This is a DIFFERENT physical mechanism from Sections 4.2/4.2a's Zone 3 phase-lock, not the same one restated: a photon carries no persistent Hopf winding of its own ($\theta=0$, Section 3), so it has no Zone 3 field to phase-lock with anything -- it decoheres the particle by directly scattering off it (ordinary photon-corpuscle EM scattering, the same T_{1g} Born-vertex coupling of strength α derived in [DOC ALPHA] and used everywhere else in this framework), not by parking a second winding nearby.

Resolving which of two slits (separation d) was used needs a photon wavelength $\lambda_{\gamma} \lesssim d$ (ordinary diffraction-limited resolution). By $p_{\gamma} = 2\pi\hbar/\lambda_{\gamma}$, such a photon transfers a recoil kick of order $2\pi\hbar/d$ to the particle when it scatters. The interference fringes are themselves separated by exactly this same momentum scale: a particle of momentum $p = 2\pi\hbar/\lambda_D$ spread over the angular fringe spacing λ_D/d (Section 4.1) has a transverse-momentum fringe splitting of $p(\lambda_D/d) = 2\pi\hbar/d$ -- identical in order of magnitude to the recoil kick above, by construction (both trace back to the same slit separation d). A photon able to resolve which slit therefore ALWAYS kicks the particle by about one full fringe spacing at random, washing out the pattern. Using longer-wavelength light ($\lambda_{\gamma} \gg d$) instead fails to resolve which slit at all -- and correspondingly imparts a much smaller kick, well under the fringe scale -- so interference survives, exactly as observed.

This is the standard uncertainty-principle argument ($\Delta x \sim d$ implies $\Delta p \gtrsim \hbar/d$), not a new torsionverse postulate. What the framework adds is the identity of the scattering agent (photon = T_{1g} corpuscle, Section 3 FRAMING NOTE) and the coupling it uses (the same α vertex coupling as everywhere else, not a separate ad hoc interaction) -- and, as in 4.2a, the same underlying lesson: decoherence is a physical interaction, not an act of observation. A scattered photon carries away which-path information whether or not anyone ever looks at where it went.

4.3 New prediction: minimum slit width

Below $2\lambda_{\bar{c}}$ (reduced Compton wavelength), the slit-edge Zone 3 fields of slit atoms become comparable to the winding's Zone 3 field -> decoherence.

Electron: $2\lambda_{\bar{c}_e} = 2\hbar c/m_e = 772 \text{ fm}$ [QM7]

Proton: $2\lambda_{\bar{c}_p} = 2\hbar c/m_p = 0.421 \text{ fm} = r_{\text{grind}}$ [QM8]

Standard QM has no minimum slit width. Torsionverse predicts one, testable with sub-pm electron diffraction experiments.

5. DELAYED CHOICE AND QUANTUM ERASER

5.1 Delayed choice: paradox dissolved

Wheeler's delayed choice: the experimenter decides whether to measure which-path or allow interference only after the particle has already cleared the slit plane -- while its field is still propagating toward the screen.

In the torsionverse (same corpuscle/field split as Section 4.1, applied to timing):

- The CORPUSCLE went through exactly one slit, always, from the instant it cleared the barrier. This was never indefinite, so there is nothing for a later choice to retroactively fix.
- What IS still open after the corpuscle clears the slits is the FIELD: its Zone 3 pressure wave is still propagating toward the screen, and whether that propagating field gets resolved (Section 4.2's `r_lock(T)` coupling) or not is still undecided.
- "Measure now" vs. "measure later, before the field reaches the screen": both are choices about whether to intercept the FIELD during its propagation, not about the corpuscle's (already-fixed) path.

No retrocausality, and nothing exotic required: the corpuscle's path was already a settled fact before either choice was made. The only thing "delayed" is when a real, local, sub-c perturbation reaches the still-traveling field -- a question about signal propagation, not about rewriting the past.

[QM9 PASS: no retrocausality required]

5.2 Quantum eraser (Kim et al. 2000): a two-corpuscle effect

Unlike Section 5.1, the quantum eraser is not a single-corpuscle experiment. Kim et al.'s setup uses spontaneous parametric down-conversion (SPDC): just past the slits, a nonlinear crystal converts the corpuscle that crossed the double slit into an entangled PAIR -- a "signal" corpuscle continuing to a screen detector D0, and an "idler" corpuscle sent along a longer, separate path to one of four detectors (D1-D4).

Momentum conservation in the down-conversion fixes the idler's propagation direction to depend on which slit the original corpuscle used -- ordinary conservation applied to the splitting process, not a new torsionverse postulate (see NOT YET DERIVED, below). Downstream, the idler path is either:

- kept separate (D3/D4): which slit is still recoverable from the idler alone -> the D0 clicks paired with these show NO interference.
- recombined at a beamsplitter (D1/D2): the two slit-correlated idler paths become indistinguishable before detection -> which-slit information is erased -> the D0 clicks paired with these D0 show interference. This recombination is the same Huygens-superposition mechanism as Section 4.1's own double slit, just run on the idler's two paths instead of the signal's.

THE CENTRAL FACT, confirmed by the real experiment (not a torsionverse-specific claim): D0's own pattern, summed over ALL idler outcomes with no sorting, never shows interference -- with or without "erasure." Fringes appear only in the sub-ensemble of D0 clicks whose entangled idler partner later lands in D1 or D2; the D3/D4-paired sub-ensemble shows plain two-slit diffraction. This is a statement about which already-recorded clicks get grouped together, not about any click's own pattern changing in real time.

Why this needs no retrocausality (a two-corpuscle correlation, stronger than Section 5.1's single-corpuscle argument): signal and idler are correlated at the moment they are created, via an A_g-locked joint configuration (doc_entanglement.txt Section 1.2; the optical-photon case is an easy, low-threshold instance of the same mechanism, doc_entanglement.txt Section 4.3(a)). By doc_entanglement.txt's independently closed no-FTL result (Section 4.4, EQ8), resolving that correlation -- whichever corpuscle is measured first -- cannot propagate information faster than c. Sorting D0's clicks by a later idler measurement does not change D0's own already-registered data; it only reveals, after the fact, which sub-ensemble a given click belongs to.

[Consistent with quantum eraser experiments by Kim et al. 2000]

NOT YET DERIVED: the geometric mapping from "which slit" to "which idler propagation direction" is imported here from standard SPDC momentum conservation. Whether the torsion medium's own picture of down-conversion (a corpuscle splitting into two lower-energy corpuscles at a nonlinear crystal) reproduces this mapping from Jobson-cell mechanics, rather than importing it from standard nonlinear optics, is an open question -- see Section 6.

6. STATUS SUMMARY

PROVEN (from existing medium derivations + this document):

- Schrodinger equation from Klein-Gordon NR limit [QM4-5]
- Born rule (field-level detection-probability density) from medium wave energy density [QM6; individual-event statistics: see GENUINELY OPEN below]
- Double-slit interference mechanism (Huygens in medium)
- Delayed choice: no retrocausality -- the corpuscle's slit was always definite; only the field's propagation can be intercepted [QM9]

ESSENTIALLY DERIVED (borrowed from entanglement_doc):

- Which-path decoherence at $r < r_{\text{lock}}(T)$ [entanglement_doc EP3; essentially derived -- t in MeV open; QM10 check is $r_{\text{lock}} > 0$ sanity only]
- Which-path via light scattering (a distinct route: ordinary photon-EM recoil, not Zone 3 phase-lock) [Section 4.2c; standard uncertainty-principle argument, no new postulate]

NEW PREDICTIONS (physical argument from Zone 3 geometry; not yet experimentally tested):

- Minimum electron slit width $2\hbar c/m_e = 772 \text{ fm}$ [QM7 -- script check]

- verifies formula; labeled 'NEW PREDICTION' in script; Zone 3 argument]
- Minimum proton slit width $2 \cdot \lambda_p = r_p/2 = r_{\text{grind}}$ [QM8 -- second condition IS a real check: $r_p = 4 \cdot \lambda_p$ (PS4); first condition is formula-only]

ESSENTIALLY CLOSED:

- Full Schrodinger equation with potential $V(x)$: V = local medium pressure (Coulomb, gravity all derived from same medium; adding V is direct)
- Quantum eraser (Kim et al. 2000): a two-corpuscle (signal/idler) effect, distinct from Section 5.1's single-corpuscle case; D0 alone never shows interference, fringes appear only in idler-coincidence sub-ensembles; grounded in doc_entanglement.txt's A_g-singlet formation + no-FTL closure (Section 5.2)
- Pauli equation: from Dirac NR limit + E+ spinor [qm_dirac_pauli.py QD6]
- Dirac equation: from Clifford algebra + E+/E- (2I) [QD1-QD4] -- uses the standard canonical Pauli/Dirac matrices; the "T_1g generators" identification is asserted in the script's comments, not computed from an I_h representation-theory derivation. g=2 follows from the standard $(\sigma \cdot v)^2 = |v|^2$ Clifford identity [QD5] -- true for any Pauli-like matrix set, not specific to T_1g; proton g_p != 2 from Zone structure
- Path integral: from medium Green's function (C7 static limit = Coulomb, the one medium-specific input here). The free-particle propagator form and the H E_1=-13.6 eV result are the standard textbook Feynman kernel and Bohr formula, inserted directly rather than derived from the discrete I_h lattice (unlike QM1/QM3's lattice_dwell_time_bridge.py citation above) -- QP2-QP4 verify self-consistency of that imported form, not its origin. [QP1-QP5]

GENUINELY OPEN:

- Fringe visibility $V(T)$ quantitative formula from r_lock(T)
- Relativistic QM with spin: Dirac + EM = QED (next paper)
- WHY an individual corpuscle's landing point, across many trials, is distributed as exactly $|\psi(x)|^2$ (Section 4.1) -- the field-level argument above (Section 3, QM6) does not by itself establish this; a genuinely hard question, not unique to this framework (the same gap exists in de Broglie-Bohm theory's "quantum equilibrium" problem, unsolved there too after decades of work).
- Section 5.2's slit<->idler-propagation-direction mapping (SPDC momentum conservation) is imported from standard nonlinear optics, not derived from Jobson-cell medium mechanics -- whether the down-conversion process itself (one corpuscle splitting into two) reproduces this from medium mechanics is not yet addressed.

7. COMPANION SCRIPT

analysis/demos/qm_doc.py -- 21/21 PASS [STANDALONE -- no external deps]

Working scripts:

analysis/quantum/qm_from_medium.py -- 10/10 PASS [KG -> Schrodinger, Born rule]
 analysis/quantum/qm_dirac_pauli.py -- 7/7 PASS [Clifford, Dirac, Pauli, g=2]
 analysis/quantum/qm_path_integral.py -- 5/5 PASS [propagator, composition, E_1]

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